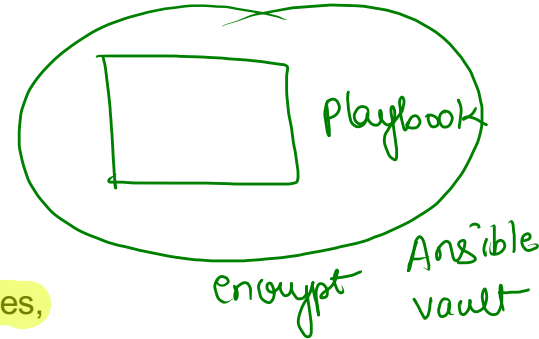


🔒 What is Ansible Vault?

Ansible Vault is a feature of Ansible that allows you to **securely store sensitive data**, such as:

- Passwords
- API keys
- SSH private keys
- Certificates
- Any confidential variables or files

Instead of keeping plain text secrets in your playbooks or variable files, Ansible Vault **encrypts** them.



🔍 Why use Ansible Vault?

When you're working in teams or storing your playbooks in a Git repo, you don't want sensitive data to be exposed.

Ansible Vault helps you **encrypt and decrypt** data as needed, safely and easily.

Create a new encrypted file:

ansible-vault create myplaybook.yml



it will prompt for pass you can put the pass

then editor will open and you can create the playbook

```
---
- hosts: all
  become: true
  tasks:
    - name: do nothing
```

```
devops@ip-172-31-4-38:~$ ls
myfile.txt myfile.yml myfirstplaybook.yml mysecondplaybook.yml swaprup.txt thirdplaybook.yml
devops@ip-172-31-4-38:~$ cat myfile.yml
$ANSIBLE_VAULT;1.1;AES256
33363666386636623037616563333732383664366561306336393138643433363335636138643234
3933663836646433346230316434633039333836623632620a643662383838346666353566663834
33373365613630323338373261383265316233393637326262656237383636346139343461353337
3961353539353734650a37623666343336636538396134316233364343763666533376361303632
32323832313062373430346666626231633430643538336264386131396333343533373462353831
383637366664386633656433386234303364386332326666666613039646237396639336531363765
61386339623036613433343663343733336566653531303861343730356663613337376363393732
38653637376362653066
devops@ip-172-31-4-38:~$
```

} encrypted file

edit an encrypted file:

```
ansible-vault edit myfile.yml
```

Pass prompt will come. put the password
yaml file will open for you.

Encrypt an existing yaml file (playbook)

ansible-vault encrypt existingplaybook.yml

```
devops@ip-172-31-4-38:~$ ls  
myfile.txt  myfile.yml  myfirstplaybook.yml  mysecondplaybook.yml  swaprup.txt  thirdplaybook.yml  
devops@ip-172-31-4-38:~$ ansible-vault encrypt myfirstplaybook.yml  
New Vault password:  
Confirm New Vault password:  
Encryption successful  
devops@ip-172-31-4-38:~$ cat myfirstplaybook.yml
```

```
$ANSIBLE_VAULT;1.1;AES256  
62393430663566613234633939383134316566376164313039383065626439313337346163323638  
3063343963303633366664383030346562366461613162370a653031336238386135316165346139  
32366336653962306363333964383635326334316161356137326430636164643931366166363333  
3262633434653866370a393236393362316338383439666435366130333164303230323439656661  
37346339626233666434313930393965313632666339663933386263323631656337653266353933  
34373731646363646432623132333262383039343862656139353965663863316262373164393531  
33353937373564316338626231623238393565333231306463376235643161646166373035383263  
63336235366138393061623063626536326335336437613538393434316330393230353861626265  
66376562316466663730373430343733643433343634333031346165656665373739656239326362
```

we encrypted existing playbook

encrypted

Decrypt the encrypted file

we encrypted in previous step.

```
devops@ip-172-31-4-38:~$ ansible-vault decrypt myfirstplaybook.yml ✓
```

```
Vault password:
```

```
Decryption successful
```

```
devops@ip-172-31-4-38:~$ cat myfirstplaybook.yml ✓
```

```
---
```

```
- hosts: all
```

```
  become: true
```

```
  tasks:
```

```
    - name: Install apache
```

```
      ansible.builtin.package:
```

```
        name: apache2
```

```
        state: present
```

```
    - name: Start service apache, if not started
```

```
      ansible.builtin.service:
```

```
        name: apache2
```

✓ decrypted

execute the vault playbook

```
devops@ip-172-31-4-38:~$ ansible-playbook myfile.yml --ask-vault-pass  
Vault password:
```

